B

AIRWAYS

To Fly. To Serve.

RULES & KNOWLEDGE BASE

Official Policies • Cabin Standards • Passenger Rights
Baggage Rules • Executive Club • Route Information
Special Services • In-flight • Travel Documents

Generated: 30 August 2026
Version 2.0 — RAG Knowledge Base
For internal AI assistant use and staff reference.

12 Policy Sections

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1. BAGGAGE ALLOWANCES

Hand Baggage (All Tickets)

- 1 cabin bag: max 56 × 45 × 25 cm (including handles and wheels)
- 1 personal item: max 40 × 30 × 15 cm (handbag, laptop bag)
- Max 23 kg each. 1 baby changing bag also permitted free of charge.
- Items must fit in the overhead locker or under the seat in front.

Checked Baggage by Cabin

- Hand Baggage Only / Basic fare: 0 checked bags
- World Traveller (Economy): 1 × 23 kg
- World Traveller Plus (Prem Eco): 2 × 23 kg
- Club Europe (Short-haul Business): 2 × 32 kg
- Club World / Club Suite (Business):2 × 32 kg
- First Class: 3 × 32 kg
- Max bag dimensions: 90 × 75 × 43 cm per piece.

Executive Club Tier Bonuses

- Bronze: Priority bag delivery, no extra bag.
- Silver: 1 extra checked bag + 32 kg allowance in Economy.
- Gold: 1 extra checked bag + 32 kg allowance, overweight waiver on 1 bag.

Excess & Extra Baggage Fees

- Pre-purchase online via Manage Booking (up to 30% cheaper than airport).
- Short-haul extra bag: from £65 online / £85 airport.
- Long-haul extra bag: from £95 online / £130 airport.
- Overweight (23–32 kg): £65 online / £85 airport.
- Oversize bag: £65 online / £85 airport.

Sports Equipment & Restricted Items

- Golf clubs, skis, surfboards, bikes count as 1 checked bag.
- Bikes must be in a padded bag/box.
- Oversized musical instruments require their own seat (book in advance).
- Lithium batteries >160 Wh are banned from all BA flights.
- E-cigarettes / vapes must be in carry-on only, not hold.
- Power banks max 100 Wh — carry-on only.
- Hoverboards banned on all BA flights.
- Liquids in hand baggage: max 100 ml containers in 1 resealable transparent bag.

2. EXECUTIVE CLUB & AVIOS

Tier Overview

- Blue (0 TP): Base Avios earn, reward flights from 4,750 Avios.
- Bronze (300 TP + 2 flights/yr, oneworld Ruby):
  Priority check-in, free standard seat 7 days before, 25% Avios bonus.
- Silver (600 TP + 4 flights/yr, oneworld Sapphire):
  Galleries Club lounge + 1 guest, free seat at booking, 50% Avios bonus, extra bag 2×32 kg in Economy.
- Gold (1,500 TP + 4 flights/yr, oneworld Emerald):
  Galleries First + Concorde Room + 1 guest, The First Wing LHR, free exit rows at booking, 100% Avios bonus.
- Concorde Room Card: 5,000 lifetime TP.
- Gold Guest List: 3,000 TP (exclusive benefits).

Avios Earning Rates

- Economy (World Traveller): 50% of miles flown
- Premium Economy (WT Plus): 75% of miles flown
- Business (Club World / Club Suite): 150% of miles flown
- First Class: 300% of miles flown
- Tier bonus applied on top: Bronze +25%, Silver +50%, Gold +100%.
- Avios never expire with 1 qualifying transaction every 36 months.

Tier Points per Route Type

- Short-haul Economy (Club Europe cabin): 10 TP
- Short-haul Business (Club Europe): 30 TP
- Long-haul Economy: 40 TP
- Long-haul Premium Economy: 80 TP
- Long-haul Business: 120 TP
- Long-haul First Class: 200 TP

Spending Avios

- Reward Flight Saver (short-haul): from 4,750 Avios + £1.
- Economy !’ Business upgrade: from 7,500 Avios/segment.
- Economy !’ First Class upgrade: from 12,500 Avios/segment.
- Hotel nights: from 4,000 Avios/night.
- Club World NYC reward return: 80,000 Avios + £350 taxes.

Companion Voucher

- BA American Express Premium Plus card: spend £12,000+ per year.
- 2nd passenger travels free on any BA reward flight (only taxes for 2nd pax).
- Or 50% Avios discount when travelling solo.
- Valid 2 years from issue. Can be used for any cabin on any BA route.

Family Account

- Pool Avios between up to 7 family members.
- Tier Points and tier status are individual — not pooled.
- All members must share the same residential address.

3. CABIN CLASSES

First Class

- Private suite with sliding door, 198 cm flat bed.
- White Company duvet and pillow, on-demand à la carte dining.
- Laurent-Perrier Grand Siècle champagne.
- 3 × 32 kg checked bags.
- Routes: LHR–JFK, LHR–DXB, LHR–NRT, LHR–SYD, LHR–SIN, LHR–BOM.
- Concorde Room lounge access included.

Club Suite (New Business Class — A350 / B777)

- Direct aisle access from every seat, full-height privacy door.
- 79-inch flat bed, 18.5-inch 4K touchscreen.
- On-demand fine dining, noise-cancelling headphones.
- 2 × 32 kg checked bags.
- Available on A350-1000 and B777-300ER.

Club World (Legacy Long-Haul Business)

- 183 cm flat bed, White Company bedding.
- Multi-course dining on fine china, champagne.
- 2 × 32 kg checked bags.
- Being progressively replaced by Club Suite on refurbished aircraft.

Club Europe (Short-Haul Business)

- Middle seat always kept empty for privacy.
- Hot meal and champagne service.
- Galleries Club lounge access.
- 2 × 32 kg checked bags.
- Group 1 boarding priority.

World Traveller Plus (Premium Economy)

- 38-inch seat pitch, dedicated cabin.
- Sparkling wine, 3-course meal on fine china, amenity kit.
- Free seat selection at booking.
- 2 × 23 kg checked bags.

World Traveller (Economy)

- 31-inch seat pitch, 10-inch personal screen.
- USB-A, USB-C, and AC power socket.
- Complimentary meal and drinks on all flights.
- 1 × 23 kg checked bag (Standard fare).

4. AIRPORT LOUNGES

Galleries Club

- Locations: LHR T5 South/North/B, T3, LGW South, JFK T8.
- Eligible: Club World/Club Europe pax, oneworld Business class, **Silver/Gold EC members + 1 guest (any cabin).**
- Facilities: Hot buffet, champagne bar, showers, Wi-Fi, quiet zone.

Galleries First

- Locations: LHR T5 South, LGW South.
- Eligible: First Class pax, Gold EC + 1 guest (any cabin), oneworld Emerald.
- Facilities: À la carte dining, Laurent-Perrier champagne, Elemis spa (LHR), **private showers.**

The Concorde Room

- Locations: LHR T5, JFK T8.
- Eligible: First Class pax, Concorde Room Card holders.
- Facilities: Private dining booths, Forty Winks sleep suites, **vintage Krug champagne, Dom Perignon bar, butler service.**

The First Wing (LHR T5 only)

- Eligible: Gold EC members and First Class passengers.
- Dedicated check-in desks, private security lane.
- Direct walk through to Galleries First or Concorde Room.
- Available 04:30–21:00 daily.

5. PASSENGER RIGHTS (UK261)

Delay Compensation (BA at fault, not extraordinary)

- Flights <1,500 km: £220 per person
- Flights 1,500–3,500 km: £350 per person
- Flights >3,500 km (4h+ delay): £520 per person
- Compensation halved if re-routed within 2h/3h/4h of original arrival.

Cancellation Rights (<14 days notice)

- Same compensation as delay: £220 / £350 / £520.
- Entitled to: full refund within 7 days OR re-routing at earliest opportunity **(including on other airlines if BA cannot accommodate sooner).**
- If notified >14 days: no cash compensation.

Duty of Care

- Triggers: 2h+ delay (short-haul) or 3h+ (long-haul).
- BA must provide: free meals and refreshments (reasonable to wait), **2 free phone calls / emails, free hotel + transfers if overnight stay required, access to medical assistance.**
- Duty of Care applies even during extraordinary circumstances.

Downgrade Refund

- If placed in a lower cabin than booked:
  <1,500 km: 30% of ticket price refunded
  1,500–3,500 km: 50% of ticket price refunded
  >3,500 km: 75% of ticket price refunded
- Claim at the airport or via ba.com/help/delays.

Extraordinary Circumstances (No Cash Compensation)

- Severe weather, volcanic ash, ATC strikes, security threats, **bird strikes, medical emergencies, hidden manufacturing defects.**
- Note: Duty of Care still applies even if extraordinary circumstances.

How to Claim

- Online: ba.com/help/delays — submit within 6 years.
- Include: booking reference, flight number, date, reason given, receipts.
- BA must respond within 14 days.
- Escalate to CEDR (Centre for Effective Dispute Resolution) or CAA if refused.

6. BOOKING & MANAGE MY BOOKING

Accessing Your Booking

- Go to ba.com !' Manage My Booking.
- Enter 6-character booking reference (PNR). No surname required.
- Available actions: view itinerary, change seats, add baggage, request meals, **upgrade with Avios, cancel booking.**

Changing Your Flight

- Flexible fares: change free, any time, no fare difference.
- Standard Economy: change fee £60–£200 + fare difference.
- Sale fares: date change only, no route changes, plus fare difference.
- Same Day Change (SDC): flat fee, subject to availability, Silver/Gold priority.

Cancellations & Refunds

- Fully Flexible fare: full cash refund within 7 days.
- Standard fare: taxes and fees refunded (£50–£200 admin fee).
- Sale / HBO fare: taxes only refunded.
- BA cancels your flight: full cash refund within 7 days, regardless of fare.

Seat Selection

- Economy: £10–£45, or free 24h before departure.
- Extra Legroom / Exit Row: £25–£80.
- World Traveller Plus: free at booking.
- Club World / Club Suite: free at booking.
- Bronze EC: free standard seat 7 days before.
- Silver / Gold EC: free at booking, including exit rows.

Name Corrections

- Minor correction ("d3 characters): free via Manage Booking.
- Full name change: not allowed — cancel and rebook required.
- Name must exactly match passport. Check carefully at booking.

Upgrades

- Avios upgrade Economy !' Premium Economy: from 7,500 Avios/segment.
- Avios upgrade Economy !' Business: from 12,500 Avios/segment.
- Bid Upgrade: submit a cash bid 3–7 days before departure.
- Companion Voucher: 2nd passenger free on reward flights (BA Amex Premium Plus).

7. CHECK-IN & BOARDING

Online Check-In

- Opens: 24 hours before scheduled departure.
- Access via ba.com or BA app using 6-character booking reference.
- Digital boarding pass: Apple Wallet, Google Wallet, or PDF.
- Must submit Advance Passenger Information (API) for USA, Canada, Australia.

Airport Deadlines

- Bag drop closes:

  Long-haul: 60 minutes before departure.

  Short-haul: 45 minutes before departure.
- Gates close: 20 minutes before departure — arrive at gate early.
- Check-in desk closes: 45 min (short-haul), 60 min (long-haul) before.

Boarding Groups

- Pre-board: Families with young children, special assistance.
- Group 1: First Class, Gold EC, oneworld Emerald.
- Group 2: Club Suite/World, Club Europe, Silver EC, oneworld Sapphire.
- Group 3: World Traveller Plus, Bronze EC, oneworld Ruby.
- Group 4/5: World Traveller (Economy) by zone.

8. SPECIAL SERVICES

Special Meals (Order 24h before via Manage Booking — all free)

- MOML — Halal
- KSML — Kosher
- HNML — Hindu Non-Veg
- VGML — Vegan
- GFML — Gluten Free
- DBML — Diabetic
- CHML — Child (2–12)
- BBML — Baby (<2)
- LSML — Low Sodium
- FPML — Fruit Platter
- SFML — Seafood
- VJML — Vegetarian Jain
- VLML — Low Calorie
- LCML — Low Cholesterol

Infants & Children

- Infants under 2: travel free on lap (1 per adult).
- Bassinet/COTS on long-haul: free, pre-book in advance.
- Stroller/buggy allowed to aircraft door.
- Child meals (CHML) available for ages 2–12.

Unaccompanied Minors

- Ages 5–11: Unaccompanied Minor service required.
- Fee: £40 each way (waived for Gold EC members).
- Direct flights only, escorted throughout the journey.
- Must be booked at least 24h before departure.

Special Assistance

- Wheelchair codes: WCHR (walks short distances), WCHC (full), WCBD (dry battery).
- Blind / deaf / other assistance — all free, request at least 48h before.
- MEDIF medical form required for certain medical conditions.
- Assistance dogs travel free in cabin (PETC) with documentation.

Pets

- No pets in the cabin (except guide/assistance dogs).
- Pets in hold: some routes via BA World Cargo at cargo.ba.com.
- Carrier must be IATA-approved, advance booking required.

9. IN-FLIGHT SERVICES

Wi-Fi & Connectivity

- Available on most long-haul and many short-haul aircraft.
- Free messaging (WhatsApp, iMessage, SMS) for all Executive Club members.
- Full browsing: £3.99/hour or £9.99 flight pass.
- Streaming available on A350 and select B777.
- Bluetooth headphone pairing: A350 and select B777 aircraft.

Entertainment

- 1,000+ hours of on-demand movies, TV shows, music, and games.
- Pause and rewind any content at any time.
- Noise-reducing headphones provided in Club World and First Class.
- Power: USB-A + USB-C + AC socket at every long-haul seat.

10. TRAVEL DOCUMENTS & VISAS

Passport Requirements

- Passport must be valid for at least 6 months beyond your return date.
- Some destinations (EU) accept national ID cards.
- Check requirements via TIMATIC at ba.com before booking.

USA, Canada & Australia

- USA: ESTA required. Apply online at esta.cbp.dhs.gov — 72h before.
  Cost: $21. Valid for 2 years / multiple trips.
- Canada: eTA required for most foreign nationals. Online, CAD $7.
- Australia: ETA or eVisitor — apply online, may be instant.
- UAE: Visa on arrival for UK/EU passport holders (30 days free).

Advance Passenger Information (API)

- Required for flights to USA, Canada, Australia, UAE, Saudi Arabia.
- Enter passport details via Manage Booking before online check-in.
- Details must exactly match your passport.
- Failure to submit API may prevent check-in.

Travel Insurance

- BA recommends comprehensive cover: medical, cancellation, baggage.
- EHIC / GHIC (UK residents): free emergency medical cover in EU/EEA.
- BA insurance via AXA: ba.com/travelinsurance.

11. KEY ROUTES & SCHEDULES

Long-Haul Routes from London Heathrow

- LHR !’ JFK (New York): Up to 8 daily. 7h 15m. B777-300ER & A350.
- LHR !’ DXB (Dubai): 3 daily. 6h 50m. A380 & B787-10.
- LHR !’ NRT (Tokyo): Daily BA005. 13h 40m polar route. B787-9.
- LHR !’ SYD (Sydney): Daily BA015 via SIN. 21h 30m total.
- LHR !’ SIN (Singapore): Daily. 12h 55m. B787-9.
- LHR !’ BOM (Mumbai): Double daily. 9h 15m. B787-9 & B777.
- LHR !’ CPT (Cape Town): Direct. 11h 20m. Seasonal frequency.
- LHR !’ MLE (Maldives): Direct. 10h 30m. Best Nov–Apr.
- LHR !’ DEL (Delhi): Daily. 8h 45m. Best Oct–Mar.

Short-Haul Routes from London

- LHR !’ BCN (Barcelona): Up to 6 daily. 2h 15m. A320neo.
- LHR !’ CDG (Paris): Up to 7 daily. 1h 15m. A320/A321.
- LHR !’ AMS (Amsterdam): Multiple daily. 1h 20m.
- LHR !’ FCO (Rome): Daily. 2h 40m.
- LHR !’ MAD (Madrid): Daily. 2h 20m.
- LGW !’ ORL (Orlando): Daily. 9h. Leisure routes.
- LGW !’ CPT (Cape Town): Seasonal. Leisure route.

Best Time to Visit Key Destinations

- New York: Apr–Jun, Sep–Nov (mild weather, fewer tourists).
- Dubai: Nov–Mar (avoid Apr–Oct extreme heat 40°C+).
- Tokyo: Mar–May (cherry blossom), Sep–Nov (autumn foliage).
- Sydney: Sep–Nov, Mar–May (Southern Hemisphere spring/autumn).
- Maldives: Nov–Apr (dry season, best visibility for diving).
- Barcelona: Apr–Jun, Sep–Oct (warm but not peak summer prices).
- Mumbai: Nov–Feb (dry, cooler, avoids monsoon Jun–Sep).

12. CURRENT OFFERS & PROMOTIONS

Active Promotions (2026)

• Summer Escape Sale: Up to 30% off Europe + North America.
Travel by 31 Aug 2026. Promo code: SUMMER30.
• Business Class Deal: Club World from £1,299 return to New York.
Valid to 30 Sep 2026. Code: BIZCLASS.
Includes lounge access + 2×32 kg bags.
• Double Avios: 2× Avios on all direct BA flights.
Book by 31 Jul 2026. Opt-in via EC account. Code: DOUBLEAVIOS.

Reward Flight Saver (RFS)

• Short-haul from 4,750 Avios + £1 (taxes).
• Medium-haul from 9,000 Avios.
• Long-haul from 20,000 Avios (economy, off-peak).
• Club World to NYC return: 80,000 Avios + £350 taxes.
• First Class to NYC return: 100,000 Avios + £350 taxes.

RAG SYSTEM USAGE

What is this document?

This PDF is the official B Airways Rules & Knowledge Base used to power the AI Voice Assistant RAG (Retrieval-Augmented Generation) system. It contains all airline policies, cabin standards, passenger rights, baggage rules, and route information.

How to upload to the RAG system

1. Navigate to the Admin Panel in the B Airways app.
2. Click "Upload PDF to RAG" in the Knowledge Base section.
3. Select this file (BA_Rules_Knowledge_Base.pdf).
4. The system will parse, chunk, and index the document automatically.
5. The voice assistant will begin using the new knowledge immediately.

Updating the knowledge base

To update policies: edit generateBARulesPDF.js and regenerate. Then re-upload the new PDF. Old chunks are replaced automatically. The RAG system supports multiple PDFs — each is chunked and merged with the existing BM25 + vector indexes.

API Endpoint

POST /api/rag/upload-pdf
Content-Type: multipart/form-data
Field: file (PDF, max 10 MB)
Response: { success: true, chunks: N, filename: "...", pages: N }